***Features***

1. Identifies the host on a network.
2. Scans ports.
3. Can interrogate network services on remote devices to determine the version name.
4. Determines the operating system and hardware characteristics of the network devices.
5. Can interact with the target using a scripting engine.

**Open VAS:** OpenVAS is an open source vulnerability scanning suite that started from a fork of the Nessus engine. It is also called the open vulnerability assessment system. It is basically a software framework consisting of different services and tools that offers vulnerability scanning and vulnerability management using a Web based dashboard.

***Features***

1. It can detect various security issues in all types of servers and network devices.
2. It understands and lets users know about what is being exposed on any external facing services.
3. Results obtained after scanning are delivered to our email address for analysis, allowing us to start fixing any kind of risks that our systems may face due to external threats.

**OpenSSH:** OpenSSH is a suite containing different secure networking utilities that are based on the Secure Shell (SSH) protocol. It provides a secure channel over an unsecured network in a client-server architecture. It was created by OpenBSD developers as an alternative to SSH. OpenSSH is not just a single computer program, but a set of programs that serves as alternatives to different unencrypted protocols like FTP and Telnet. It is integrated to several operating systems while its portable version is available as a package in a specific system.

***Features***

1. Uses a bi-directional data-forwarding technique that helps return communication to the client side server.
2. It can set up a secured channel through which all the data sent to local or client-side UNIX domain sockets and client-side TCP ports may be easily forwarded for routing on the server side.
3. It secures all the traffic between two points by tunnelling all insecure protocols through an SSH tunnel.
4. It includes SCP, which provides easy access to copy files securely.
5. It can access internal network services with the help of SSH tunnels using a single point of access.

**OSSEC:** This is also known as Open Source HIDS Security. It is an open source, host based intrusion detection system widely used to perform log analysis, integrity checks and Windows Registry monitoring. It's also used for rootkit detection, time based alerting and active response. It supports intrusion detection for most of the operating systems including OpenBSD, Linux, OS X, Solaris, Windows, etc.

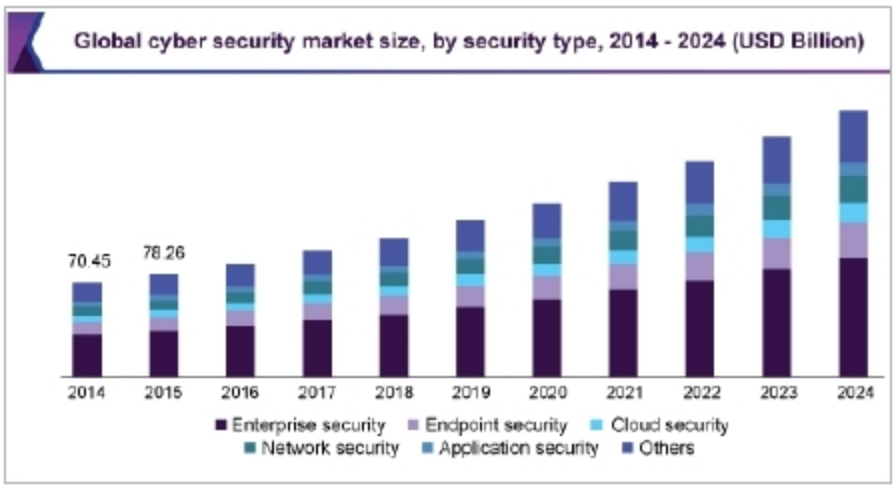



Figure 3: Increase in the size of the global cyber security market (2014-2024) (Image source: *googleimages.com*)

***Features***

1. Easy to set up and configure.
2. OSSEC has a centralised and cross-platform architecture that allows multiple systems to be easily managed and monitored at the same time.
3. It has a log analysis engine that can correlate and analyse different logs from multiple devices and formats.
4. OSSEC is compliant with the Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard requirements.
5. It has benefits for both the security and operations staff.

## Tips for securing a home network

Here are a few common but important tips that can add a lot to the security of a local network.

1. Change the admin user name and password for routers on a continuous basis.
2. Activate encryption.
3. Change the network name on a regular basis.
4. Always turn off the guest networks when not required. This will keep strangers away from being able to randomly hop on.
5. Activate the encryption for all files present on the local network.
6. Double up on firewalls.
7. Always keep the firmware updated on all the devices connected to the local network. END

## References

[1] *http://www.wikipedia.org/*
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